# Visitor Identification: What We Need From You

Oct 27, 2026 · @Aaqib Ali Shehzad

## Summary

We can build visitor identification on the RTI website, but we need 6 answers from the admin team and 10 decisions from management before we start. No visitor identification code has been written yet.

The cookie banner it depends on is already built and on the dev site. The full technical review is in M0-INVENTORY.md.

## Questions for the admin team

The site sits behind the admin team's AWS proxy, so only they can tell us how the real visitor IP reaches our server. Without this, every visit could show the proxy's IP instead of the visitor's.

1. Which header carries the real visitor IP: X-Forwarded-For, X-Real-IP or another?
2. Does your nginx replace that header, or add to the value the browser sent?
3. Is a CDN or Cloudflare in front of the AWS proxy?
4. Can the proxy send the visitor's country in a header?
5. Does the proxy cache or rate limit /api/ requests, and does it pass cookies through unchanged?
6. Which IP addresses belong to the proxy itself?

## Decisions for management

Each row needs one choice. Where we have a recommendation it is in the last column; please confirm or change it.

| # | Decision | Options | Our recommendation |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | How the scheduled jobs run (enrichment every 10 minutes, daily digest at 7 am Central) | A: scheduler inside the website app. B: server crontab. C: a separate worker process | A, it needs nothing new on the server |
| 2 | Do dev and live use the same database? | Yes or no | Need to know. If yes, dev must not run the jobs |
| 3 | Country lookup for the EU/UK check | Free DB-IP file the site already uses, or MaxMind (needs an account and licence key) | DB-IP, already in place |
| 4 | Status for visitor leads | Add new statuses to the existing leads, or a separate visitor status | Separate status, so form leads stay exactly as they are |
| 5 | Scope of "no raw IP stored" | New visitor tables only, or also the IP we already save on form leads and newsletter sign ups | Needs your decision |
| 6 | Ad click cookie (rti_attr) | Keep it as it works today, or change it to first touch as the brief says | Keep it, the lead emails and Ads reporting use it |
| 7 | Who can see the Visitors page | Names and roles of each person, plus who sees the dark launch | Please list the names |
| 8 | Test tool | node --test (nothing to install) or vitest | node --test |
| 9 | Branch name and who deploys | feat/visitor-identification or phase2/visitor-identification; Aaqib or Anees deploys and runs database changes | Needs your decision |
| 10 | Tawk chat | Load only after the visitor accepts cookies, or count it as necessary | Needs your decision |

## What the cookie banner changes

The new banner follows your five rules, and it changes what we track for visitors who do not accept:

- Google Ads conversions and call number tracking only count visitors who accept cookies.
- Leads from visitors who decline show "Direct / unknown" in the lead email Source section.
- Visitor identification will also only run for visitors who accept, as the brief requires.
- The privacy policy paragraph must be live before anything goes to production.

## Next steps

Work starts as soon as the answers are in. The brief's dates are the privacy paragraph live on Nov 5 and the dark launch on Nov 6; the first setup step (M0) was planned for Oct 27 to 28 and moves with the answers.

1. The admin team answers the 6 questions above.
2. Management fills in the decisions table and approves the plan.
3. We build M0: setup, database tables and the IP lookup test, on a separate branch.
4. We show M0 on dev before moving to the next milestone.